[50] Wynch to Ashe from Madras Club, undated (but likely in the second week of December 1908), Ashe Papers, Ireland.

[51] Wynch to Souter, dated 27-3-1908, Secret Bundle no 35, 'Swadeshi Steamer Co., Tuticorin'.

[52] MPAI, 1908, para 521(b).

[53] Ibid.

[54] 'Sedition in Tinnevelly.'

[55] Wynch to D.W.G. Cowie, the IG of Police, dated 20-3-1908, 'Sedition in Tinnevelly'.

[56] Notes by J.N. Atkinson, Murray Hammick and Gabriel Stokes, 'Sedition in Tinnevelly'.

[57] Here, Wynch was certainly being economical with the truth. BI and Chapman were very much interested in talking to SSNCo—even if their intentions were less than noble. A police report of April 1908 mentions SSNCo's overtures to BI for assistance (MPAI, 1908, para 521(b)). This seems to have been such common knowledge that *The Hindu* reported that Chapman had 'desperately rushed' to a director of SSNCo suggesting dissolution (*The Hindu*, 15-5-1908). When Cox, Ashe's successor, gratuitously reminded everyone that the Tuticorin–Colombo line was only a small fraction of BI's business the conclusion to be drawn was that BI had, if nothing else, at least lost its peace of mind, and was keen to ensure SSNCo's closure (*The Hindu*, 15-5-1908. For the Tamil version of Varaprasadam Pillai's evidence, see *Swadesamitran*, 24-3-1908, reprinted in *Kumari Malar*, May 1981.) It was of a piece with Lord Inchcape's strategy to bleed the competition and then buy it up. For instance, when Lalubhai Samaldas went up to him to end the rate war, he contemptuously offered to buy up the Scindia Steam Navigation Co. (Mehta, *Indian Shipping*, p. 31).

[58] This section is based on the brief report in MPAI, 1908, 962(a) and the full text of Wynch's letter to the chief secretary, Atkinson, dated 7-7-1908, 'Sedition in Tinnevelly'.

[59] Wynch's letter to the chief secretary, Atkinson, dated 12-7-1908, 'Sedition in Tinnevelly'.

[60] Ibid.